

Challenge: Enhance!

Category: Forensics

Description: The challenge provided a downloadable SVG image file, with the flag hidden somewhere inside it rather than visible in the rendered image.

Approach: I downloaded the file using `wget` while the challenge page was open and logged in on Kali's browser, using the direct link from there — this ensured the download carried an authenticated session rather than returning a login page (an issue I'd hit on a previous challenge). I confirmed the file type with `file drawing.flag.svg`, which showed it was a genuine SVG (Scalable Vector Graphics) image. Since an SVG is text underneath its visual rendering, I used `cat drawing.flag.svg` to read its raw contents directly, rather than opening it as a picture. The flag was divided into multiple parts, embedded within text elements in the file's header section.

Difficulty Faced: Finding the flag required careful, close reading of the file's contents, since it wasn't presented as a single visible string — it was split into separate fragments within the text elements, and spotting all the pieces and reading them in the correct order took close observation rather than a simple search.

Tools used: `wget`, `file`, `cat`

Flag: `academy{3nh4nc3d_001f8059}`

What I learned: An SVG file is fundamentally a text-based (XML) format, not a binary image format like PNG or JPG — meaning it can be read directly as text, and anything hidden inside its markup (including a flag split across multiple text elements) is recoverable with basic file-reading tools rather than requiring specialized image-analysis software. This also reinforced the importance of confirming a file's actual type with `file` before deciding how to approach it, since assuming a file only exists in the form its extension suggests (e.g., "it's an image, so I need an image viewer") can lead you to overlook the simpler, correct approach.